PRESS KIT

Held Close Books

JUST HOLD HER

A Foster Mother's Memoir of Medicine, Caregiving, and the Long Nights Together

Judy Wright

Proclamation Honoring Judy & John Wright	Foster Parents of the Year	John & Judy Wright Scholarship
Oakland County Board of Commissioners	Michigan Supreme Court	Ennis Center for Children

> *"Would you, please… just hold her until she dies?"*

THE STORY

That was the call. Two months old. Four pounds. Blind, deaf, and tethered to monitors, Jayden came with twenty-seven diagnoses and no plan. They didn't ask Judy Wright to save her. They asked her to stay.

Just Hold Her is the true story of a foster mother's long nightwatch. Built from the spiral notebooks Judy kept during a two-year vigil, her literary memoir follows what happened when an end-of-life placement became something more demanding: a daily life shaped by medicine, bureaucracy, attachment, and the steady labor of care.

In a house governed by two-hour feeding cycles and the shrill cry of medical alarms, Judy learned to trade big hope for small mercies. While the system prepared for the end, morning kept arriving… and with it the ordinary, difficult work of beginning again: warming the bottle, checking the numbers, drawing the dose, and asking the one question no one else was willing to ask:

What about breast milk?

This is not a rescue story. It is a witness story… for caregivers, foster parents, and the medical professionals who know what it means to stay when medicine has reached its edge.

COMPARABLE TITLES

- *When Breath Becomes Air* — Paul Kalanithi
- *The Bright Hour* — Nina Riggs
- *Being Mortal* — Atul Gawande
- *The Year of Magical Thinking* — Joan Didion
- *Another Place at the Table* — Kathy Harrison

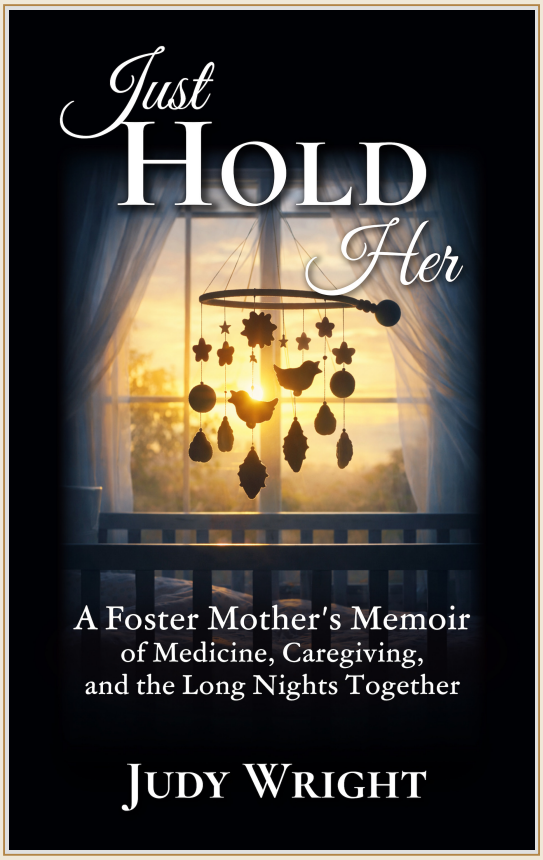
ADVANCE PRAISE

"A fantastic read. A true testament to modern medicine, unconditional love, and compassion. I could not put it down."

Linda Thulin — Nurse, Caregiver, Mother

"You feel every emotion in this book. I found myself holding my breath. A wonderful read."

Jeanette Cunningham — Medical Professional



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ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Judy Wright

Judy Wright is a Michigan mother, foster mother, and caregiver. Over twelve years in Oakland County, she and her late husband John fostered fifty-five children, many of them medically fragile. In 2012, they were named Michigan Foster Parents of the Year by the Michigan Supreme Court and Oakland County Foster Parents of the Year, receiving the Honorable Joan E. Young Award for Commitment to Children. Their legacy continues through the John and Judy Wright Scholarship for Foster Children, established in partnership with the Ennis Center for Children. *Just Hold Her* is her debut memoir.

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